



Financial market participation 2020, 2023–2026

A record of the journey and participation in the financial
markets: what was traded, how, and where things stand today.

Foabao

September 2026

Five calendar years, six markets and three routes in: the journey so far

5 calendar years of participation	19 accounts across three routes	2,124 trades logged	6 market types: FX, futures, stocks, commodities, metals, crypto
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How it began. The journey started in March 2020, when a first personal account was opened as COVID volatility peaked. After a pause, participation resumed in September 2023 and has been continuous since, so it now spans five calendar years: 2020, and 2023 to 2026.

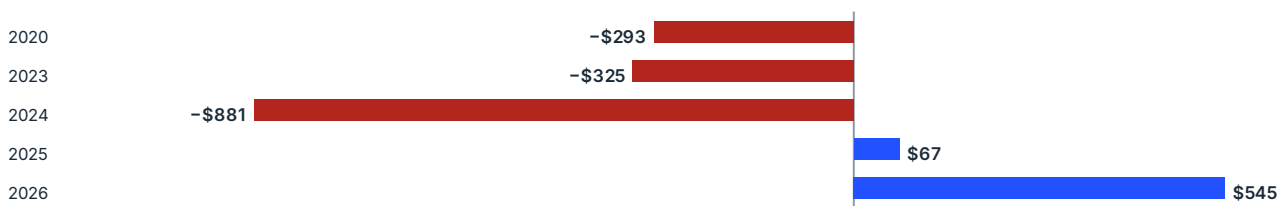
How it broadened. From 2023 the journey widened beyond currencies (foreign exchange, or FX) to oil and gold, then in 2024 to silver, US index futures, Bitcoin and Nigerian stocks, and in 2025 to US stocks. Three routes in have been used: personal accounts; accounts with proprietary trading firms ("prop firms"), each beginning as a paid evaluation of trading ability; and 1kHooD, a US stock fund run with a limited partner. Together that is 19 accounts and 2,124 trades.

Prop firms. 15 prop-firm accounts were run at a cash cost of \$1,016 in fees. They provided \$291,000 of account capacity and produced an account-level result of -5.4%. Two stages were passed; no payouts have been received.

The equity funds. Both are active. 1kHooD earned **+\$681** on \$1,000 (68%). The Nigerian stock account, traded on the Nigerian Exchange (NGX), earned **₦92,037** net of fees on **₦150,000** (61%).

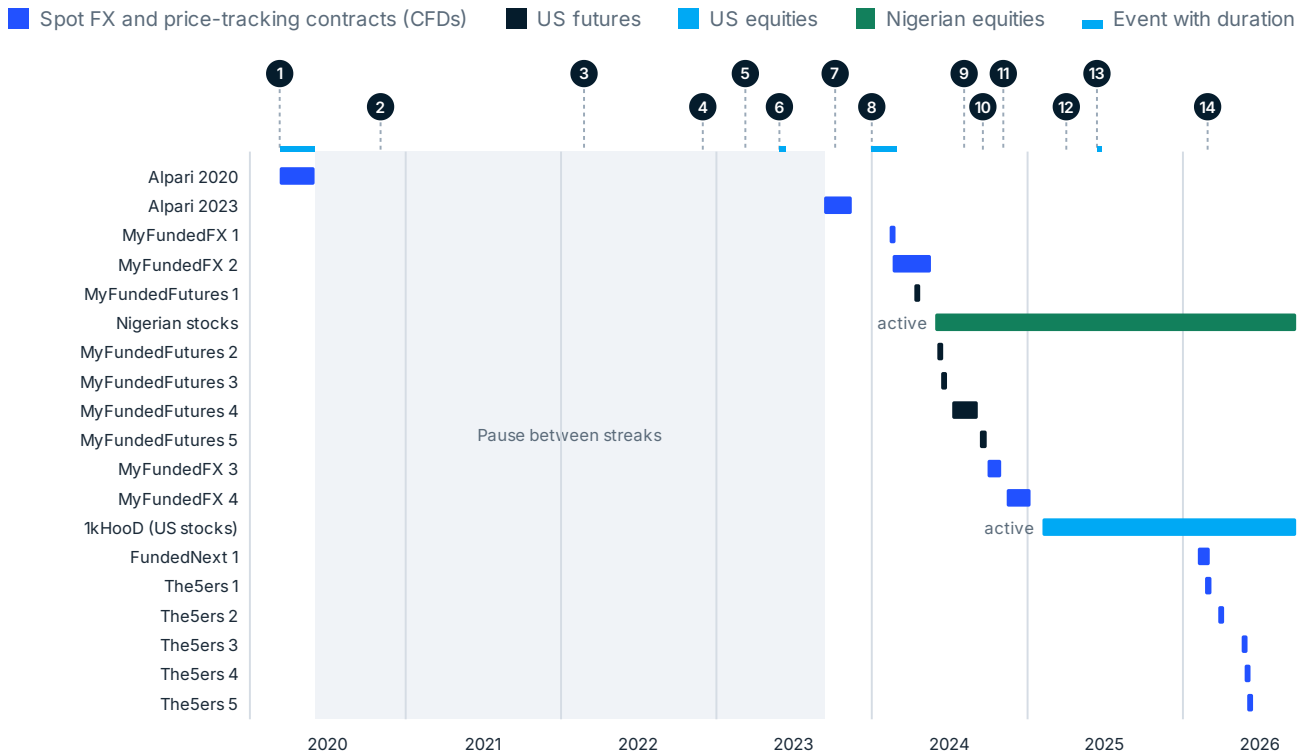
Where it stands. As of September 2026 the cash result across all accounts is **-\$886**, up from a low of **-\$1,499** at the end of 2024; 2025 and 2026 were each positive, led by the two equity funds. The journey drew on personal (24%), friend (49%) and family (27%) capital, of which 61% went into US instruments, 35% into global FX and 4% into Nigerian stocks. **₦400,000** of **₦720,000** has been repaid to one family lender, and 1kHooD has distributed \$1,458 to its partners.

Net cash result by year (USD)



Results are shown on a cash basis: personal-account outcomes, prop-firm fees, and fund trading results. Evaluation-account profit and loss is reported separately as a memo item.

Participation has run in two streaks: 2020, then continuously since September 2023



2020. One personal FX account, opened as COVID volatility peaked. **September 2023 to date.** The second streak began with a personal account and nine prop-firm accounts in FX and index futures through 2024. Nigerian stocks started in 2024 and 1kHooD in 2025, and six further prop-firm accounts ran in 2026. Both funds remain active. Numbered markers refer to the events on the next page.

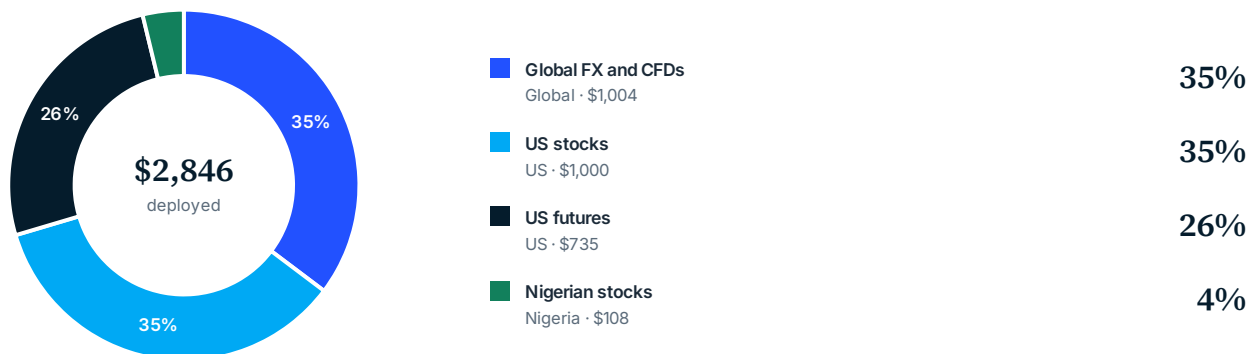
Each phase of participation overlapped a major macro or geopolitical shock

#	Period	Event	Relevance to the markets traded
1	11 Mar 2020 – 1 Jun 2020	COVID-19 pandemic and market crash	Record volatility; first live account (Alpari 2020) traded through it
2	3 Nov 2020	US presidential election	Rotation and volatility in US equities and the dollar
3	24 Feb 2022	Russia–Ukraine war begins	Energy and grain shock; commodity and inflation repricing (no participation, 2021–22)
4	30 Nov 2022	ChatGPT released	Start of the AI investment cycle behind later US equity leadership
5	10 Mar 2023	Silicon Valley Bank collapse	Regional-bank stress; rates repriced
6	29 May 2023 – 14 Jun 2023	Nigeria: subsidy removal and FX unification	Naira devalued; reshaped the cost of dollar capital
7	7 Oct 2023	Israel–Hamas war begins	Oil and gold volatility; Alpari 2023 traded WTI and gold
8	1 Jan 2024 – 29 Feb 2024	Naira sell-off	Peak dollar cost for Nigerian funders during the 2024 evaluations
9	5 Aug 2024	Yen carry-trade unwind	Sharp fall across markets during the futures evaluations
10	18 Sept 2024	Fed begins cutting rates	Start of the easing cycle
11	5 Nov 2024	US presidential election	Trend day for US indices and the dollar
12	2 Apr 2025	US “Liberation Day” tariffs	Global equity sell-off and rebound; 1kHooD first year
13	13 Jun 2025 – 24 Jun 2025	Israel–Iran 12-day war	Oil and gold spike
14	28 Feb 2026	Iran war and Strait of Hormuz crisis (ongoing)	Oil spike toward \$120 (Brent); US blockade of Iranian ports 13 Apr–29 May; Nigerian stock gains in 2026

Dates for 2026 events are from public reporting as of September 2026; the Hormuz crisis is ongoing.

61% of capital went to US markets and 35% to global FX; Nigerian equities are a small third leg

Where the capital went, by market



By region: US 61%, Global 35%, Nigeria 4%.

By market type

Market type	Region	Trades	Prop -firm and personal accounts	Funds
Futures	US	1,092	-\$13,948	–
Equity indices (CFDs)	US	48	-\$368	–
US stocks	US	350	–	+\$681
Nigerian stocks	Nigeria	29	–	+\$67
FX	Global	269	-\$1,398	–
Commodities	Global	302	-\$438	–
Metals	Global	30	-\$276	–
Crypto	Global	4	-\$6	–
Total		2,124	-\$16,434	+\$748

US covers futures, equity indices (CFDs) and the 1kHooD stock portfolio. Global covers FX, commodities, metals and crypto, all traded through contracts for difference (CFDs), which track a price without owning the asset. Crypto is four BTCUSD trades in one 2024 evaluation. Prop and personal account figures are account-level results, including evaluation accounts. Fund figures are 1kHooD (USD) and Nigerian stocks (converted to USD at prevailing monthly rates).

Prop evaluations: 15 attempts, \$1,016 in fees, \$291,000 of account capacity

15 prop-firm accounts across four firms provided \$291,000 of account capacity at a cash cost of \$1,016 in fees (0.35% of capacity). The aggregate account-level result was -5.4%. Two stages were passed at The5ers; no payouts have been received.

Entry path	Accounts	Capital deployed	Cash result	Status
Retail investing (personal accounts)	3: Alpari 2020, Alpari 2023, Nigerian stocks	\$830	-\$551	Alpari closed; Nigerian stocks active
Prop firms	15: four firms	\$1,016	-\$1,016	All closed; 0 payouts
Managed portfolio (1kHooD)	1: Robinhood, general and limited partner	\$1,000	+\$681	Active
Total	19	\$2,846	-\$886	

Prop firms: totals by firm

Firm	Accounts	Size per account	Total account size	Total fees paid	Total account-level result	% of total size	Stages passed
MyFundedFutures	5	\$50,000	\$250,000	\$734.50	-\$13,948	-5.6%	0
MyFundedFX	4	\$5,000	\$20,000	\$148.22	-\$1,602	-8.0%	0
FundedNext	1	\$6,000	\$6,000	\$63.21	-\$361	-6.0%	0
The5ers	5	\$2,500-\$5,000	\$15,000	\$70.50	+\$94	+0.6%	2
All four firms	15		\$291,000	\$1,016.43	-\$15,817	-5.4%	2

Totals are summed across each firm's accounts, and each account is counted at its full size, including later stages of the same evaluation.

Evaluation fees by firm

MyFundedFutures	\$735
MyFundedFX	\$148
FundedNext	\$63
The5ers	\$71

Three of the five MyFundedFutures evaluations ended at about -4% (\$2,000 each), consistent with a fixed maximum-loss rule set by the firm. Retail accounts are self-directed personal accounts. The managed path is 1kHooD, a fund run as general partner with TA as the limited partner. Both stages passed were at The5ers in May 2026; the funded account that followed ran for one day.

The journey was funded mainly by friends and family (76% of \$2,846), with 24% personal capital

Capital deployed by source

IF	PO	TA	MO	BA
24%	6%	44%	13%	14%
\$679	\$163	\$1,240	\$361	\$403

IF: personal TA, PO: friends (TA a close friend; PO contributed in 2020 only) MO, BA: family

Where each source went (USD)

Destination	Personal (IF)	Friend (PO)	Friend (TA)	Family (MO)	Family (BA)	Total
Alpari 2020	131.58	163.13	–	–	–	294.71
Alpari 2023	75.35	–	156.27	195.64	–	427.26
MyFundedFX evaluations (4)	64.22	–	84.00	–	–	148.22
MyFundedFutures evaluations (5)	274.50	–	–	165.00	295.00	734.50
FundedNext and The5ers evaluations (6)	133.71	–	–	–	–	133.71
1kHooD fund	–	–	1,000.00	–	–	1,000.00
Nigerian stocks (brokerage account)	–	–	–	–	107.64	107.64
Total	679.36	163.13	1,240.27	360.64	402.64	2,846.04

Any funding not explicitly attributed to a source is treated as personal (IF). BA's ₦442,500 for futures costs is \$295 at ₦1,500/\$; its ₦150,000 into Nigerian stocks is recorded as \$107.64.

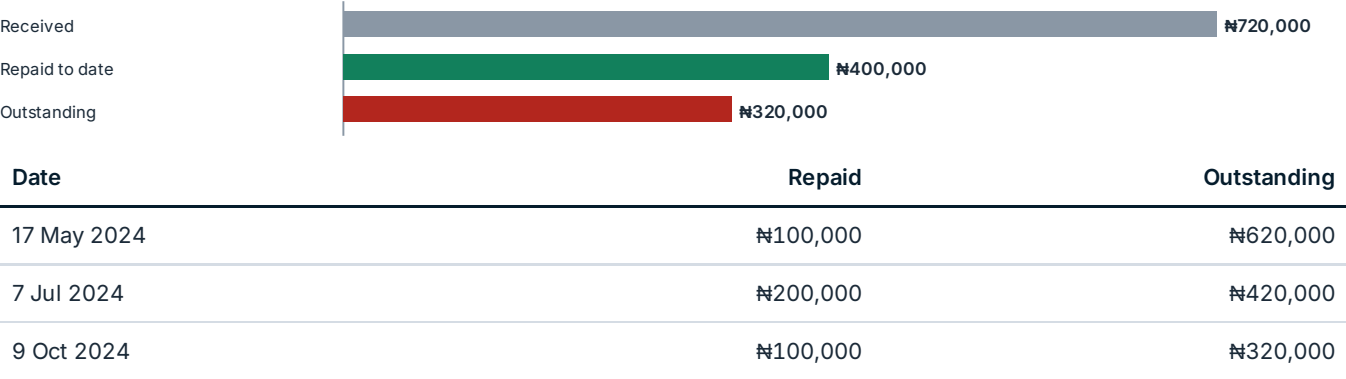
Received versus deployed (family, ₦)

Source	Received	Deployed in markets	Into operations
MO (₦420,000 investment, ₦300,000 loan)	₦720,000	≈ ₦398,000	≈ ₦322,000
BA	₦1,000,000	₦592,500	₦407,500

Return of capital has begun, and 1kHooD distributes to its partners

Partial return of capital has begun: ₦400,000 of ₦720,000 has been repaid to one family lender, and 1kHooD has distributed \$1,458 to its partners.

Repayments to family lender MO (₦)



Outstanding shown in payment order; the source log lists the 9 Oct 2024 payment first.

1kHooD: capital, profit and distributions (USD)



21 withdrawals total \$1,458.39 since Sep 2025, split by the fund’s general and limited partner shares in pounds sterling (55% and 45%). They exceed cumulative trading profit of \$680.85, so they include a partial return of contributed capital; the implied balance is \$222.46.

Source	Nature of return		Status
IF (personal)	None expected		–
PO, TA (friends)	TA: distributions as limited partner in 1kHooD. PO: none		TA receiving; PO none
MO (family)	Repayment of credit	₦400,000 of ₦720,000	
BA (family)	Repayment target	None yet	

Returning capital to every source remains a stated target for the journey.

The cash result bottomed in 2024; 2025 and 2026 both finished net positive

By year (USD, cash basis)

Year	Personal accounts	Prop fees	1kHooD	Nigerian stocks	Net result	Memo: evaluation accounts
2020	-\$293	+\$0	+\$0	+\$0	-\$293	+\$0
2023	-\$325	+\$0	+\$0	+\$0	-\$325	+\$0
2024	+\$0	-\$883	+\$0	+\$1	-\$881	-\$15,265
2025	+\$0	+\$0	+\$68	-\$1	+\$67	-\$285
2026	+\$0	-\$134	+\$612	+\$67	+\$545	-\$267
Total	-\$618	-\$1,016	+\$681	+\$67	-\$886	-\$15,817

Cumulative cash result: -\$293 (2020) → -\$618 (end-2023) → -\$1,499 (end-2024) → -\$1,432 (end-2025) → -\$886 (September 2026)

By entry path



By market type, account-level result including evaluation accounts



Overall: **-\$886** on \$2,846 deployed (-31%). **Status:** 17 accounts closed, 2 active. Nigerian stocks in naira: ₦111,942 gross, ₦19,905 fees, ₦92,037 net across 29 closed trades.

Equity funds, both active. 1kHooD: **+\$681** on \$1,000 (68%), with \$1,458 distributed to its partners. Nigerian stocks: ₦92,037 net on ₦150,000 (61%) across 29 closed trades.

Pattern recognition is the core thesis; trades per evaluation fell from 164 in 2024 to 27 in 2026

Primary approach. Generating value from the markets through the application of the art, science and technology of pattern recognition.

Art

Reading structure, context and behaviour in price: the discretionary judgement of what a pattern means now.

Science

Testing whether a pattern repeats with an edge: samples, expectancy and risk limits rather than anecdote.

Technology

Encoding what works into indicators, dashboards and automated systems so it can be applied without drift.

Supporting lenses

Lens	Role
Technical analysis	Structure, levels, momentum and reversal signals across FX, futures and stocks
Fundamentals	Sector and company selection for the equity funds, including thematic sector intelligence
Events	Macro and geopolitical catalysts: rates, elections, wars, supply shocks (see events, page 4)

Evidence from the record

Evaluations in 2024 averaged 164 trades each, and the largest reached 584; in 2026 they averaged 27. Measured against account size, the 9 evaluations of 2024 ended -5.8% and the 6 of 2026 ended -1.3%; 0 of 9 finished positive in 2024 and 2 of 6 in 2026. The samples are small and the firms, account sizes and instruments differ, so this is indicative rather than proof. The equity funds are the profitable strand.

Tooling built along the way

Rule-based systems and dashboards are part of the approach: automated trading rules for two trading platforms, an intraday trading engine, charting indicators, and a sector-intelligence tool.

Basis of preparation

Cash basis. Personal accounts show cash result; prop firms show the evaluation fee paid; funds show trading result before the general and limited partner split. Evaluation-account profit and loss is memo only.

Currency. Reported in USD. Nigerian stock results are recorded in naira and converted to USD at approximate monthly ₦/\$ levels: recorded rates for 2024 and published Central Bank of Nigeria levels for 2025–26 (about ₦1,360–1,530). Family amounts are shown in naira as recorded.

Nigerian stocks. Gains in the trade sheet are before fees; fees are deducted here, giving ₦92,037 net, which agrees with the sheet's realised total. One open position (6 shares of Geregu Power, bought for ₦5,400) is not yet sold and is excluded; at the price recorded in the sheet it is ₦446 below cost.

Data gaps. Alpari 2020 predates detailed trade records (account-level only). MyFundedFX #2 is partly summarised, MyFundedFX #4 comes from the firm's performance report, and Alpari 2023 uses cash result (–\$324.93) rather than the trade record (–\$284.73).

Funding rule. Unattributed funding is personal. No prop payouts, no other accounts, and no participation in 2021–22.

Sources. Account and trade-level portfolio records, Nigerian stock trade records, and the family credit and repayment log. Event dates are from public reporting. Data as of September 2026.

Terms. A prop firm is a proprietary trading firm that lets a trader use its account after passing a paid evaluation. FX is trading one currency against another; futures are standardised contracts on an index or commodity. A CFD is a contract for difference, which tracks a price without owning the asset. NGX is the Nigerian Exchange, where Nigerian stocks are traded. Alpari is the online broker used for the two personal accounts. In 1kHooD, the general partner runs the fund and the limited partner provides the capital.